

ERIKA COWAN

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SYSTEMS LEADER

Educator | Developer | Analyst | Project Manager

Operations and technology leader with a background spanning enterprise financial systems, data analytics, and custom software development. Builds automation, reporting, and internal applications that replace manual processes and give leadership usable data for decisions. Experience covers financials, multi-entity accounting, enterprise reporting, systems administration, and integrations across education and corporate environments.

Highlights of Expertise

- **Enterprise Systems** – Administering and improving information systems, including SAP, Munis, Cognos, eSchoolPlus, Skyward, and related platforms while resolving transaction, integration, access, and data issues that affect day-to-day operations.
 - **Accounting Operations** – Implementing and adhering to strict GAAP standards, supporting all accounting functions, including reviewing and analyzing financial data, preparing journal entries, P&L, and cash flow and cost reports.
 - **Financial Reporting** – Gathering complex data and crafting detailed ad hoc reports, expense analysis reporting and daily / monthly budget variance analysis to support management's decision-making process.
 - **Data Analysis** – Utilize outstanding analytical abilities to devise and implement accurate expense tracking models, deploying "Best Practice" internal control solutions that improve overall business operations.
 - **Project Management** – Directing multiple concurrently running projects; interfacing with key stakeholders and business leaders to define project scope, identify key business drivers, and create actionable plans.
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

LEWISVILLE INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT, LEWISVILLE, TX

CTE Educator | Campus Skyward Coordinator | Gradebook Mentor | Webmaster & Social Media Lead, 7/2024 to Present

Lead data, systems, automation, gradebook, and digital operations while teaching computer science and digital media. Manage tools and processes supporting student data, reporting, intervention, staff systems, and communications affecting 47,000+ students and 6,000+ employees.

Key Achievements:

- ◆ Increased staff productivity by 25% by centralizing gradebook procedures, system resources, operational tools, and recurring workflows into a single digital environment.
- ◆ Reduced administrative processing time by 40% by replacing manual detention, tutoring, credit-recovery, and parent-communication workflows with centralized applications and automated notifications.
- ◆ Cut leadership reporting and intervention-analysis time by 50% by consolidating fragmented student performance data into a multi-campus decision-support system.
- ◆ Reduced recurring gradebook administration by 25% through API-driven automation between Canvas, grading workflows, and instructional data.
- ◆ Increased industry credential attainment to a 91.46% combined pass rate across Adobe Illustrator and Adobe Express certification exams.

GILBREATH-REED CAREER AND TECHNICAL CENTER, Garland, TX

Educator / TATF Liaison | Accounting, Finance & District Systems, 7/2023 to 7/2024

Led dual-credit Accounting and Finance instruction while improving district data, reporting, automation, and staff-development processes supporting 50,000+ students and district employees.

Key Achievements:

- ◆ Improved data accuracy by 40% by redesigning student-information and attendance controls, validation, and exception-management processes.
- ◆ Increased data-processing productivity by 30% by automating recurring workflows and eliminating duplicate manual record handling.
- ◆ Reduced recurring system-support demand by 25% by standardizing procedures and leading districtwide training in enterprise systems, data practices, advanced Excel, and accounting.
- ◆ Accelerated staff onboarding by 30% by developing standardized system documentation, job aids, and reusable training resources.
- ◆ Expanded advanced Excel and accounting capability across students and educators; earned Outstanding Educator recognition and ranked #2 in Texas at the 2024 Microsoft Office Specialist U.S. Championship.

IRVING INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT, Irving, TX

Business Application Analyst & Programmer, 5/2022 to 7/2023

Managed enterprise financial, HR, reporting, identity, and student-information systems supporting 31,000+ students and 4,000+ employees. Led system administration, reporting, integrations, automation, access governance, and business-process improvement across finance, HR, technology, and district operations.

Key Achievements:

- ◆ Reduced annual compensation processing time by more than 70% by redesigning and automating calculations, validation, data movement, and reporting for 4,000+ employees.
- ◆ Cut enterprise reporting turnaround by 50% by automating high-volume reports, extracts, and data workflows across Munis, Cognos, eSchoolPlus, and integrated systems.
- ◆ Reduced repeat system incidents by 35% by resolving root causes of cross-platform data, integration, security, access, and reporting failures.
- ◆ Improved account-provisioning efficiency by 40% by standardizing identity, permissions, and access-control processes across districtwide systems.
- ◆ Increased leadership access to actionable data by replacing manual departmental reporting with automated dashboards, recurring reports, and standardized data outputs.

CTE Educator, 9/2020 to 5/2022

Taught business and technology while managing industry-certification, attendance, grading, and college/career-readiness data processes for students and campus leadership.

Key Achievements:

- ◆ Achieved a 90% industry-certification pass rate across business and technology courses.
- ◆ Reduced certification processing by 80% and cut attendance administration by 50% through automated tracking, uploads, and reporting.
- ◆ Improved college- and career-readiness data accuracy by 30% by replacing manual tracking with structured validation and reporting workflows.

FLEUR DE LIS ENERGY, LLC, Irving, TX

Property Accountant & SAP Systems Administrator, 2/2020 to 9/2020

Managed accounting and SAP financial operations across 20,000+ ownership records, including accounts payable, invoice/PO matching, vendor payments, revenue accounting, asset integration, reconciliations, reporting, and SAP administration.

Key Achievements:

- ◆ Integrated a \$1B asset acquisition into SAP within 90 days while maintaining uninterrupted financial operations and accurate ownership, asset, and accounting data.
- ◆ Saved more than \$100,000 annually by designing an SAP-based ACH and W-9 control process that eliminated manual payment-data administration.
- ◆ Increased financial reporting productivity by 40%, reduced manual errors by 20%, and shortened month-end close by 25% through automation and process redesign.
- ◆ Reduced payment exception resolution time by 30% by centralizing invoice, PO, ACH, tax-document, ownership, and transaction data used for research and reconciliation.
- ◆ Improved financial-data accuracy across 20,000+ ownership records by identifying and correcting SAP coding, payment, ownership, and transaction discrepancies.

MAVERICK FITNESS (Formerly 16 Capital Investments), Frisco, TX

Staff Accountant, 8/2019 to 2/2020

Managed accounting operations supporting 30+ Orangetheory Fitness locations and 25,000+ members within a \$1B+ fitness network. Oversaw AP, vendor payments, payroll accounting, GL activity, reconciliations, journal entries, cash flow, financial reporting, audits, and month-end close during rapid expansion.

Key Achievements:

- ◆ Earned rapid promotion to Staff Account following highly successful tenure as AP Accounting Administrator.
- ◆ Utilize advanced development skills to create and deliver automate accounting reports to support daily operations and calculating commissions for coaches and sales associates.
- ◆ Instrumental in training of new Accounts Payable personnel, ensuring team understands all processes and procedures.
- ◆ Credited for developing variety of expense trackers and implementing new reporting functions that reduce man hours.
- ◆ Successfully created/implemented new credit card reconciliation process that linked all daily credit card transactions with accounting system thus tracking daily charges in real time environment.

Accounting Administrator - Accounts Payable, 3/2018 to 8/2019

Managed daily Account Payable operations, interacted daily with the studio managers and vendors to evaluate invoices and process payments on time. Assisted management team in analyzing expenses for all locations, including adjusted and corrected inaccurate invoices, negotiated payment terms and discounts with new vendors. Monitored cash flow daily, generated monthly financial reports, and provided direct support for all audit activities. Conducted daily reconciliation of all sales and credit card transactions. Supervised annual processing of 1099's. Cross trained accounting clerk AR/AP operations.

Key Achievements:

- ◆ Credited for increasing study profits by 10% by proactively analyzing costs recommended strategies to cut costs.
- ◆ Honored by leadership team of completing the transfer of historical hardcopy accounting data to digital platform.
- ◆ Assisted team in organizing and setting up database structures to ensure easy access to the digital information.

KELLY SERVICES, INC., Plano, TX

Finance Account Executive, 9/2017 to 3/2018

Utilized proven sales insight, client development skills, and background in Accounting to build highly profitable sales channel spanning both Accounting and Financial Services customer accounts for this globally leading office staffing company. Excelled in this fast-paced, customer-facing environment, managed entire sales cycle from identifying and qualifying prospects, presented workforce solutions, and negotiated / closing contracts. Interfaced directly with clients in person, via telephone and email to promote and market candidates to prospective business. Tracked and reported achieved sales goals to the Sales Manager.

Key Achievements:

- ◆ Built and grew relations with high profile clients and community leaders to expand company image and maintain strong rapport with key decision-makers.
- ◆ Maintained an aggressive sales schedule making 100+ calls a day and attending 3+ client meetings each day that resulted in winning 15 new accounts in five months, generated \$100K in direct-hire sales and \$12.5K temp-to-hire monthly sales.
- ◆ Devised and implemented a new process to compile Accounting and Finance contact emails and names from databases and coordinate development and release of 300-500 weekly emails to set client meetings and support cold calling efforts.

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

TEXAS WOMAN'S UNIVERSITY, Denton, TX

Master of Teaching, Leadership & Collaboration (08/2024), 4.0 GPA

FRANKLIN UNIVERSITY, Columbus, OH

Bachelor of Science in Accounting Dates (12/2019), 3.81 GPA

~ Magna cum Laude Graduate / Member of Presidents List

Professional Certifications: Texas Educator Certificate: Business and Finance, Grades 6-12 • Business Administration Technical Certificate • Google Certified Trainer • Google Analytics • Microsoft Office Specialist: Excel (2013, 2016, 2019), Word (2016, 2019), Adobe Certified Professional: Content Creation & Marketing Using Adobe Express, Graphic Design & Illustration

Using Adobe Illustrator

Technical Skills: SAP ERP & Financials, Munis, Workday, QuickBooks, Paylocity, Kronos, Salesforce, Cognos, Advanced Excel, Power BI, Tableau, Looker Studio, SQL Server, SSRS, Crystal Reports, SQL, Python, JavaScript, Google Apps Script, APIs, Active Directory, Windows Server, Google Admin Console, Skyward, eSchoolPlus, PowerSchool, Canvas, Google Workspace, Microsoft 365